

A Few Useful Linux Commands for CLI Enthusiasts

Linux's forte is the command line. So here is the author's compilation of a set of Linux commands and utilities for the enthusiast and for systems administrators. Your computing experience should improve after trying out these commands.

I have put together a few Linux commands and utilities which may interest CLI enthusiasts, while being useful to systems administrators and power users. Here is a list and a brief description of each of these.

A reminder

A simple reminder can be created by combining the *at* and the *xmessage* commands. The *at* command can be used to schedule a command to be run once, at a particular time. Type the command at the prompt with the time as an option. The command then displays its prompt, where the

commands to be run can be typed, one per line. *Ctrl-D* should be used to close the prompt.

The *xmessage* command displays a simple dialog box with a message. This can be combined with the *at* command to set reminders. The message can be from the command line, a file or even the standard input. The user can click on one of the buttons in the dialog box to close the box. This can also be used to display multiple options to the user and to accept the user's choice.

```
Sat 6 pm
at>xmessage "Time for the meeting"
Ctrl-D
```

The *leave* command

The *leave* command can be used as a simple reminder.

It accepts time in the *hh-mm* format, where *hh* is in hours and *mm* is in minutes, in the 12-hour format, whatever

be the time given. It keeps displaying a message in the terminal from which the *leave* command was given. The reminder is given 5 minutes before the actual time, 1 minute before the time, at the time mentioned in the command and every minute after that, until the user logs out. It prompts users to fill in the time if no argument is given as part of the command. To remind you to leave at 5 pm, you have to give the following command:

```
$leave 1700
```

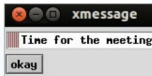


Figure 1: *xmessage* output

